



Welcome to MSU!!

Fall 2026 Orientation Slides

Who We Are?

The **Council of Graduate Students (COGS)** is the authorized student government on campus, representing all graduate/professional students at Michigan State University

Our mission is to promote the **academic**, **social**, and **economic** goals of graduate and professional students.



Governance: The Full Council

- Each department appoints a representative to the full council.
- Representatives voice issues and concerns at monthly meetings and cast a vote on behalf of their department.
- Representatives bring back resources/information and promote upcoming events to their peers.
- Meetings are hybrid, once a month on Wednesday from 6:30 – 8:30 PM – you are welcome to observe/attend as a guest too.



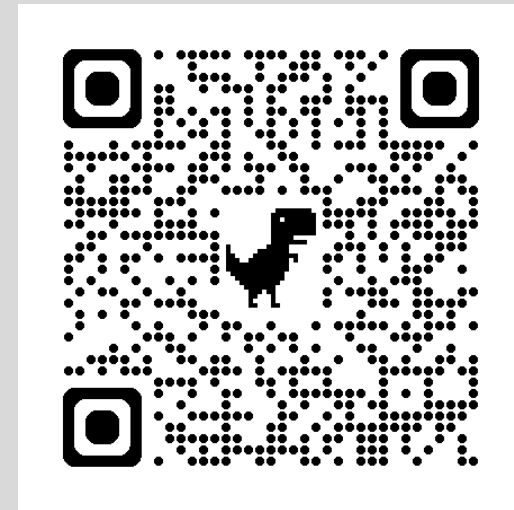
COGS Resources: Services

- Free legal services provided by Jeffries and Associates, PLLC @ Student Legal Services.
- Student Rights Advocates.
- No-interest short-term loans.
- Virtual Tax Workshops, *as planned*.
- Discounted Wharton Center tickets to select shows.



COGS Resources: Funding

- **Conference Awards:** (\$300; one-time award)
- **Professional Development Awards:** (\$500; one-time award)
- **COGS GSO Event Funding:** (Maximum of \$1,500 over the AY for registered GSO)
- **Disciplinary Leadership Award:** (\$1,000; one-time award)



Scan here to learn more
about COGS Funding!

Get Involved with COGS

Become a Representative

Speak to your
Graduate Program
Academic
Assistant

Serve on a Committee

A full list of
committees is
available on our
website at
cogs.msu.edu

Attend COGS Events

All events are open
to graduate and
professional
students at MSU.

Advocacy

Keep COGS
informed of issues
and engage with
your department
representative to
learn more.

Governance: Committee Service

University Committees



Improve overall institutional governance.



Promote the graduate student perspective regarding university-wide issues and programming.

COGS Committees



Guide COGS legislation, programming and operations.



Provide advocacy, change, and services for COGS constituents.

COGS Events

Professional/Academic

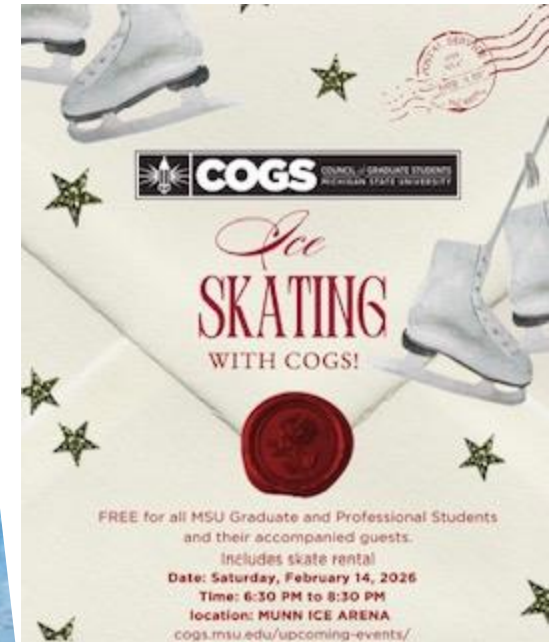
- Graduate Academic Conference
- Engaging Workshops and Collaborations with Campus Partners

Health & Wellness

- Resource Sharing
- Grow Collaboration/Workshop Series

Social Activities

- Fall Welcome
- Coffee & Connections
- Tailgates and so many more.....





Attend the Fall Welcome Celebration!

Date: August 29th, 2026

Time: 12:00 pm – 3:00 pm

Location: MSU Benefactor's Plaza
(Behind Chittenden Hall)

Join COGS & our friends from The Graduate School for resources, food, fun activities, music, prizes & giveaways... and FRIENDS as we start the new year!

August 29 Fall Welcome Events

- Graduate Resource Fair @ 10 am
 - MSU Union
- COGS Fall Welcome @ Noon-3PM
 - Benefactors Plaza
 - cogs.msu.edu/upcoming-events

**COGS FALL
WELCOME**
Save the Date:
Sat. 8/29



COGS

COUNCIL of GRADUATE STUDENTS
MICHIGAN STATE UNIVERSITY



Fall Welcome Events

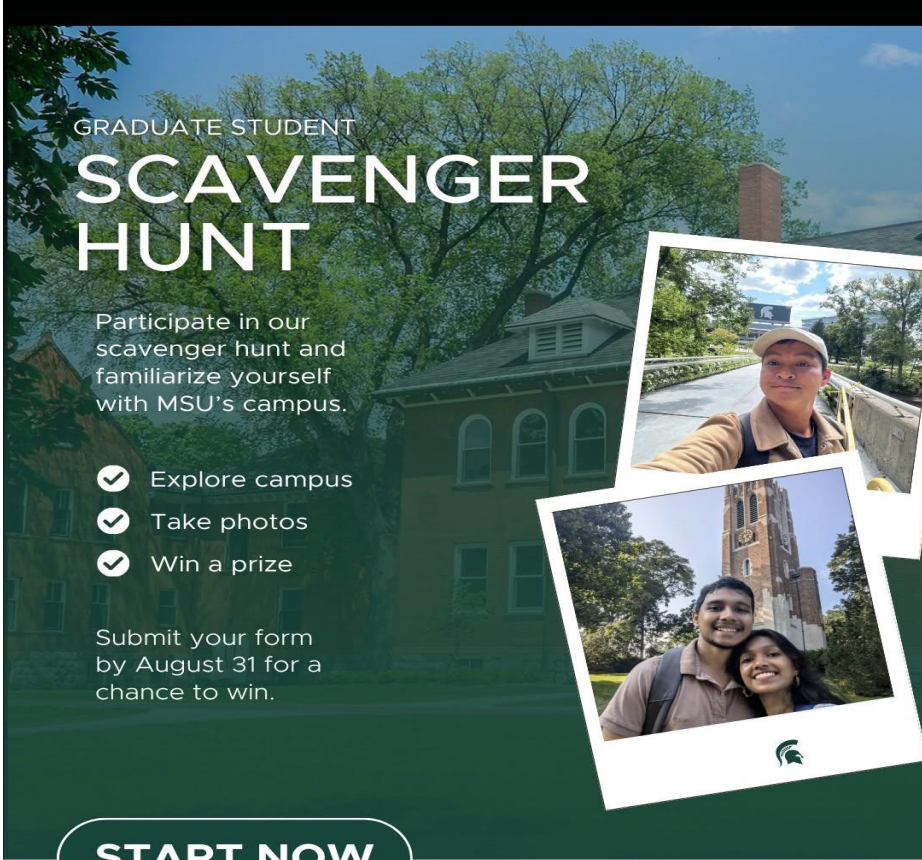


All graduate students are invited to attend!

GRADUATE STUDENT WELCOME & RESOURCE FAIR

DATE, TIME, & LOCATION

	Saturday AUGUST 29, 2026		go.msu.edu/zWk5
	10 a.m. to noon		MSU Union Ballroom
	gradschool@grd.msu.edu		



GRADUATE STUDENT SCAVENGER HUNT

Participate in our scavenger hunt and familiarize yourself with MSU's campus.

- ✓ Explore campus
- ✓ Take photos
- ✓ Win a prize

Submit your form by August 31 for a chance to win.



START NOW

<https://bit.ly/FWHUNT26>

The Graduate Academic Conference (GAC)

Practice presenting your research to other scholars and laypersons. Prizes are awarded to top presentations in each category (oral, poster, and 3-minute thesis). Abstract submission dates occur in the fall semester.

- **February 20th, 2027 at MSU Union**



What's the difference?

Council of Graduate Students



Graduate/Professional Student Government



Constituents: All tax-paying graduate and professional students.



Primary Issues: University resources/policies, graduate health and wellbeing; leadership and social issues.

Graduate Employees Union



Employee's Union



Constituents: Graduate Assistant



Primary Issues: Wages, benefits, and working conditions.

Stay Connected with US



cogs.msu.edu



MSUCOGS



cogsmsu



office@cogs.msu.edu



cogsmsu



Chittenden Hall, Room 120
466 W. Circle Drive